Manipuri hill people in Eastern India, and 13 per cent of Sinhalese in Sri Lanka were found also to have low but still significant proportions of Haplogroup R1a1a in their genetic makeup. These anomalies have been cited in support of the 'out of India' theory advanced in some Indian circles, which argues that the Indo-European language family had its origins in India. The alternative – and, to my mind, more convincing – explanation is that these isolated genetic pockets represent outriders of the Arya advance who were swallowed up by their host communities.

14 P. A. Underhill, N. M. Myres, S. Rootsi, M. Metspalu, L. A. Zhivotovsky, R. J. King, J. Roy, A. A. Lin, C. E. T. Chow et al, 'Separating the post-Glacial co-ancestry of European and Asian Y chromosomes within haplogroup R1a', *European Journal of Human Genetics* 18 (4), 2009.

15 Roberto Calasso, *Ardore*, Edizione S.p.A. Milano, 2010 (tr. Richard Dixon, *Ardor*, Allen, Lane, 2014, pp.3-6).

16 See, for example, *R-V* 7.21.15.

17 For example, animal and fire sacrifices loom large in both the Avesta and the *R-V*. In Early Iranian the term is *yasna*, in Sanskrit it is *yajna*.

18 D. D. Kosambi, *Ancient India*, 1965. See also A. Basham, *The Sacred Cow*, 1989, and more recently D. N. Jha, *The Myth of the Holy Cow*, 2001.

19 There were, of course, dogs in India and a dog's paw mark has been found in bricks at Chanhu Daro, but no evidence of domesticated dogs.

20 B. Debroy, *Sarama and her Children: the Dog in Indian Myth*, 2008.

21 In *R-V* 7.55 one of these watch-dogs is praised as 'master of the house', even though his barking irritates the household. 'Be on thy guard against the boar,' runs verse 4, 'and let the boar beware of thee. At Indra's singers barkest thou? Why dost thou seek to terrify us?